

with the force of Rambo starting a speedboat. Grab what you need and nothing more.

These few simple tips will save you money on a product every single one of us uses on a daily basis. Let's save a few trees and a few bucks at the same time. — **Paul Michael**

5 Ways to Trim Haircut Costs for Kids

Let me preface this advice by saying that I'm not above cutting my own kids' hair. We often cut their hair (especially the boys'), and in the summer, we prefer to shave it down for coolness and to avoid tick dangers. I have found great results with a mid-range Wahl hair-cutting kit, complete with all the bells and whistles. There are times, however, when it is not appropriate for me to cut their hair: My daughter is entering tweendom and needs something more stylish, or my youngest needed his first "real" cut and had more cow-



licks than I could handle, etc. How do you manage to keep up the coif and keep it under budget? Start with these simple tips.

1. Use a coupon

This should be a no-brainer, but I'm amazed at how often I forget. Many of the larger chains offer incredible savings on cuts via clippable coupons in your local paper inserts. Great Clips, for instance, drops the cost of their kid's cut several times during the year (right before school, for example). You must have the coupon, however, to get the savings.

2. Get a group rate

Planning on bringing in all four kids and the hubby for a trim? Schedule a time in advance on a day when they don't do much business. Ask if they can give you 20% off for having all the cuts done on the same day. (Don't forget to tip.)

3. Use a barber

Salons aren't the only ones equipped to handle cleanup. Our local barber